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THE Origins OF MARITIME SOCIOLOGY AND TRENDS OF ITS DEVELOPMENT.

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1. The evolution of the research area and the subject of maritime sociology in Poland.

It is quite difficult to explicitly define what is the beginning of maritime sociology as at the beginning the research area of this subdiscipline was unclear. Nevertheless, it is the year 1947[96] which is claimed to be the starting point of sociological research on people of the sea. However it would be a mistake to assume that from this date marine sociology has been functioning as a separate sociological subdiscipline. Polish interwar sociological literature references to such works, which basically may be acknowledged to be precursors in the field of maritime sociology. There are, among others:

[96] W.Bryniewicz: Geneza i dzieje socjologii morskiej, Szczecin 2004, p.39

"Kultury morskie i lądowe" by F. Bujak, „Wpływ morza na kształtowanie się psychiki narodowej" by M. Siedlecki. The basic allegation against these works is the lack of empirical study. For this reason, and because of the need to assume time censorship of the beginning of maritime sociology, we can speak about two possible origins: the first is the one which gave the possibility to recognize the sea and to form marine social reality in relation to that. The second one is undoubtedly an exploratory consciousness of sociologists, who contributed to clarifying what are the subject and the field of marine sociology. It was Z. Dulczewski who (in mentioned above 1947) carried out the first empirical research on people of the sea, fishermen, to be more precise. Thanks to that the "discovery" was made, that a new socioprofessional category appeared in social structure: people of the sea. We are in the 60,' which abound with the researches and analyses. Further views of sociologists interested in marine social reality were influenced by the monograph by A. Polańska[97], who could be praised not only for her sterling scientific work. It was thanks to this monograph, that the profession of fisherman was compiled more deeply. Scientific inspiration of A. Polańska bore fruits: in 1967 monographic study by L. Janiszewski comes out: „Rybacy dalekomorscy. Studium socjologiczne" and work by T. Olchowy: „Działalność kulturalno – oświatowa załóg statków morskich".

When looking for the beginnings of maritime sociology, it is necessary to refer to the year 1964, when term "maritime sociology" was used for the first time in Poland. It was A. Matejko who did it, in the article from "Tygodnik morski."[98] For a long time, however, "maritime sociology" is replaced with phrases such

[97] A.Polańska, Zawód rybaka morskiego w Polsce, Gdynia 1965

[3] A. Matejko, Socjologia ludzi morza, in: „Tygodnik Morski" 1964, nr 34

[4] J. Nadolski, Socjologia ludzi morza, in: „Tygodnik Morski" 1964, nr 39; J. Sztumski, Socjologia nautyczna. Przedmiot i problemy, in: „Nautologia" 1971, nr 2-4

[5] Szczecin 1977

[6] B. Chmielewska, Badania socjologiczne na Pomorzu Zachodnim w ubiegłym piętnastoleciu, in: „Kultura i Społeczeństwo" 1960, nr 4; Z. Dulczewski, Organizacja badań socjograficznych na Ziemiach Zachodnich, Zachodnich: „Przegląd Zachodni" 1958, nr 2

[7] D. Górska, Niektóre psychologiczne aspekty funkcjonowania rodziny marynarzy i rybaków, Gdańsk 1970; M. Latoszek, Styl życia rodzin stoczniowców, in: „Przegląd Zachodniopomorski" 1975, nr 2; L. Janiszewski, Rodzina marynarzy i rybaków morskich. Studium socjologiczne, Warszawa 1976; K. Wszeborowski, Wychowawcze funkcjonowanie rodzin marynarzy floty handlowej Polskich Linii Oceanicznych, in: Z. Tyszka
(ed.), Współczesne rodziny polskie w świetle aktualnych badań, Poznań 1976

as: "the sociology of people of the sea" or "nautical sociology."[99] Just in 1977 L. Janiszewski settled this term. When he was publishing "Socjologia morska. Wstęp informacyjny i bibliograficzny,"[100] he claimed that "the sociology of people of the sea" is an indispensable part of maritime sociology. The analisys of the literature in this subject allows to describe the first part of forming of maritime sociology as a historic-comparative mainstream (Z. Dulczewski, A. Polańska, L. Janiszewski, T. Olchowy). It can be mainly characterized by works dealing with changes in Polish marine economy after war, researches and analyses.[101] Simultaneously, the mainstream exposing a structural aspect is developing. It were researches and analyses indicating that there is a connection between a professional aspect of people of the sea and different apects of social life, such as: family, free time or culture on the ship.[102] Although this stage of maritime sociology development crystalized the area of research and gave it an empirical identity, it contained some mistakes, which may occur in every young subdiscipline.

Consecutive stage of maritime sociology development forms a mainstream of theoretical and methodological reflection. J. Sztumski exposes the connection between the sea and social life and structure. L. Janiszewski was focusing on social and economic processes of human activity at the sea, for the sea, and because of the sea. Work by Z. Dulczewski: „Rybacy bałtyccy. Zagadnienia stabilizacji społeczno – zawodowej," brought out a methodological value, as it contained the analysis of panel studies which have been carried out for ten years. Maritime sociologists focus much attention on such issues as: system of values of people of the sea, their life and professional expectations and roles, cultural, informal and family roles, opinions ,beliefs and views among people of the sea, concerning their work and life (autostereotypes are being studied), opinions, beliefs and views in social environments which are not connected with the sea concerning work and life of people of the sea.

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2. The genesis of field work and its importance for the development of marine sociology.

The genesis of field work goes back to the year 1947. It was then, when Poznań scientific centre carried out the first sociological research about fishermen from the middle coast. But it was Z. Dulczewski who became the precursor of the field work, when in 1956, together with academics from the Sociology Department of West Institute in Poznań, started the research on marine societies. Empirical data that have been collected then, enabled to describe professional, economical, social, and demographical changes, which were occurrying among Baltic fishermen. Also A. Polańska (from Marine Institute of Fishing in Gdynia) and her research concerning social and professional cathegories of Baltic and overseas fishermen contributed to the development of maritime sociology. T. Olchowy and E. Sitek were dealing with the field work concerning sailors from the merchant fleet. In 1967 the first sociological monography comes out, about overseas fishermen, in which L. Janiszewski included the description of those fishermen's social structure, their motifs for choosing the profession, ways and mechanisms of professional promotion, the ship as an environment of work, human relationships on the ship.

After 1967 there is the raising of researches concenrning marine matters. The process of industrialization is propitious for it, for instance in Szczecin, as a part of Social and Demographical Section of West Pomeranian Institute (the end of 1967), Panel for the Research on the Leisure Time of People of the Sea, was established. Psycho-Sociological Centres are also operating: they are dealing with social aspects of sailor's, fisherman's and harbourer's professions.

Marine Institute of Fishing in Gdynia contributed a lot to the history of maritime sociology. Its Study of Sociology and Psychology of Marine Professions was dealing with such topics as the professional adaptation of overseas fishermen, or the influence of fisherman's work on the marine ship on one's personality.

The Institute of Marine Medicine in Gdańsk, and the Faculty of Sociology WSP in Gdańsk (which in 1970 was joined to Gdańsk University), are similarly important institutions, which contributed to the researches of

maritime sociology. The Faculty of Sociology WSP in Gdańsk was greatly absorbed into matters connected with the families of sailors and fishermen.

Next to team studies, an individual researches were also carried out, which dealt with such issues as for instance: social ties on the ship, sailor's social and professional environment, personality againts adaptation to working and living at the sea, families of the people of the sea, styles of leadership on the trawler, professional cathegories of harbourers, shipbuilders and marine pilots.[103] A lot of sociologists are travelling by ship (L. Janiszewski, L. Milian, J. Nikołajew), making an active observation an important method of research in still fresh maritime sociology.

To sum up, the first stage of maritime sociology development, are mainly efforts of sociologists to gather empirical material concerning phenomena and processes in marine social reality; it is the stage of forming sociological research perspective about life and work of people of the sea. It is also the stage of emerging sociological and methodological ambitions; it is an extremely important stage of maritime sociology institutionalization as well; since 1979 the Institute of Maritime Sociology IFiS PAN has been functioning, in 1983 the Institute of Maritime Sociology of Sociology Department at Szczecin University was established, as well as "Roczniki Socjologii Morskiej" PAN.

An optimistic development of maritime sociology was held back by the transformation of system after 1989.

3. Maritime sociology after the transformation of system.

Process of the system tranformation led to a revaluation of the research problems of many scientific disciplines, including maritime sociology. Locality of maritime issues is noted, the area of research of this subdiscipline is also changing (for example the importance of tourism to the Baltic is recognized). Problems assosiated with taking the job by Polish sailors on ships flying a foreign flag are appearing. In 1998 in Szczecin at the meating of Maritime Sociology Committee PAN they outlined a new direction of this subdiscipline and highlighted its current research issues. It is worth noting that the prestige of the profession of sailor and fisherman is changing. The results of

[103] W. Bryniewicz, Geneza i dzieje socjologii morskiej, p.53 and further

the analysis made by Szczecin and Gdańsk Centre clearly show the disappearance of professional sailor and fishermen from the elite professions in Poland.

As the result of the system tranformation in Poland, maritime sociology takes a new direction of methodological and problematic development, which gives the opportunity to describe individual and collective behaviour, as well as studies of the determinants of this behaviour. It was also pointed out that the transformation of system and the tranformations occuring in the global economy create new conditions for the functioning of marine economy, which significantly determines the people of the sea. Among the most important factors influencing the mentioned community there were:

- macroeconomic changes in the maritime economy: trade economy and private ownership appeared, especially private (often foreign) owners;
- changes in the labour market in professions related to the maritime transport sector: shortages of staff in the officer's personnel and overproduction of an associate crew;[104]
- crisis in the marine economy – gradual collapse of some shipping and dock companies;
- the opening of borders and simplifications in travelling – it undoubtedly decreased the attractiveness of sailor's profession, who in socialist economy had an exceptional entitlements in this field;
- the appearance of new attractive professions which do not involve such a niusances as in the case of sailor's practice, and which brings high finansial inducements;
- change of political system, democratization of political life, encouraging of citizen's active participation in social life
- an international crew functioning on the global labor market, which creates the need for contacts with representatives of diffrent cultures.

An additional incentive for the resumption of research in the cathegory of the people of the sea was an emirical material collected earlier by the researchers

[104] It is a situaton on Polish and international labour market. World overview of marine human resources made in 1995 indicated that shortages of officer's personnel on the international labour market were 18.000 people, and in an associate crew there was an overproduction of 219.000, and what is more this phenomena was strenghtening. J. Klusewicz: Podaż i popyt marynarzy na światowym rynku pracy oraz ich wpływ na zatrudnienie polskich marynarzy, in: Problemy społeczne ludzi morza w okresie transformacji ustrojowej w Polsce, Gdańsk 1997, p. 24 - 25.

working within this sociological subdiscipline. It creates the possibility of dynamic analysis of the processes occurring in the communities of the people of the sea. Such actions of course also has their limitations, if they are to be comparative they cannot deal with issues that were not raised during the previous testing penetrations, hence the interest in cognitive focus is here in several areas. Firstly, they focus on the transformations of the people's of the sea relation to their profession, especially motifs for choosing the profession, and determinants of satisfaction from this profession. Secondly, they are connected with the workplace – the tranformations of the relationships between coworkers and factors indicating ties with the workplace. Thirdly, the subject of analysis are the people of the sea – changes in the preferred model of family formation, forming of relationships inside the families, involvement in the care of children, ways of spending leisure time. Fourthly, the attitude towards broader social environment, which was indicated by such elements as: the way of perceiving your own social status and position of other communities which belong to the same area and present social differences as well. Fifthly, marine sociologists debate also about ties with the place of living, which are manifestated in such areas of people's of the sea activity as satisfaction from the living place, cultural, social and political activity. There are also appearing some considerations concerning the consequences of globalization in marine economy.

In comparison to the period before 1989, the intensity of research and the number of publications concerning maritime sociology has significantly decreased. It should be related to the low possibility of gaining financial supplies for the realization of research in the proper subdiscipline, the collapse of some institutions connected with marine economy, for example haul companies, and the lack of interest from the other ones to realize research on their area. This is the reason why some of the publications are realized within modest possibilities of the researcher.

Although all these difficulties, Roczniki Socjologii Morskiej are still cyclically published, in which papers concerning discussed subdiscipline are included. There are also books comming out, among which we should mention work by W. Bryniewicz: „Geneza i dzieje socjologii morskiej" and U. Kozłowska „Stoczniowcy Szczecina w procesie zmian społecznych. Studium socjologiczne Stoczni Szczecińskiej SA"[105]

There is a chance that at a cyclic conference European Sociological Association in 2009 in Lisbon, for the first time in the history of this

[105] Work concerning sailors by Ż. Stasieniuk is to be published soon as well, together with works by J. Nikołajew and G. Leśniewska.

subdiscipline development, will appear a session devoted to maritime sociology (up to this moment we only know that the organizers approved of this suggestion). We hope that it will allow this subdiscipline to be more important on a broader scientific field.

To sum up, it seems that maritime sociology is currently a discipline that after the period of stagnation starts to find its place among sociological subdisciplines. It will require reformation of the research subject, which should to a greater extend desribe phenomena occurring in the global maritime economy. There is nothing else but to have a hope that the attempt to make foreign researchers interested in this subdiscipline will be successful. We should also notice that maritime theme is present in European and American researches, but it is often taken from other scientific traditions and is discussed according to different perspectives.

4. Maritime theme in the foreign research and foreign didactic studies.

The research on scientific publications as well as informational and promotional materials of scientific institutions (the end of 2007, searching through the internet, also with making use of scientific bases of, inter alia, EBSCO), showed that maritime sociology exists as a specialization or main or additional subject of interest of many scientists in the world. Here are some examples:

Professor from the university in Toronto – Barbara Neis gives maritime sociology the first place among her scientific interests, then sociology of labour, gender issues, health, sociology of knowledge. She was an editor of books which are clearly connected with the issues of maritime sociology: *Fishers' Knowledge In Fisheries Science and Management, Changing Times: Gender, Fisheries and Globalization, Finding Our Sea Legs: Linking Fishery People and Their Knowledge with Science and Management* (http://www.arts.mun.ca/sociology/home/neisb)

Anthropologists from American universities – John Poggie from the University of Minnesota among his interests puts *maritime anthropology*, as well as Richard Pollnac from the University of Missouri (http://www.uri.edu/artsci/soc/faculty.html).

Marteen Bavinck – Director of the Centre for Maritime Research (MARE) in Holland, gives lectures at a international course: an alternative way of fisheries managing and the management of maritime resources (http://www.marecentre.nl/organisation/bavinck.html).

At Greek university in Pireus M.Miliaraki gives lectures on *Sociology of Shipping* on maritime studies department.

(http://www.unipi.gr/eng_site/akad_tmhm/naut_spoud/naut_spoud_ps_math2.html)

Paul Gares from Thomas Herriot College of Arts and Science on the interdisciplinary course studies gives lectures on *Coastal and Marine Studies*, and while specyfying the subject among aspects of research in maritime resources, among biological, physical, and historical, he gives also social ones (http://www.ecu.edu/cs-acad/ugcat/CoastalMarine.cfm).

In Barcelona at the maritime studies department, maritime sociology is put among subjects to choose for the course: maritime navigation

(http://www.upc.edu/english/estudis/1ri2ncicle/f-estudis/28001.htm)

Maritime sociology appeared also in the MA syllabus from Science In Environmental Toxicology in the South Alabama

(http://www.southalablama.edu/toxicology/courses.html)

At the Canadian university maritime sociology is one of the four fields, which should be chosen as a specialization in case of applying for the PhD in sociology.

(http://www.mun.ca/regoff/calendar/sectionNo=GRAD-0459)

Craig J. Forsyth and Robert Gramling (University of Southwestern Louisiana, USA) "Adaptive familial strategies among merchant seamen" (Forsyth, Gramling, 1990[106])

[106] Forsyth Craig J., Gramling Robert, 1990, *Adaptive familial strategies among merchant seamen*, Journal of Family and Economic Issues, vol. 11, number 2/ June, p. 183-198

Strategies which were included in the article include such typologies as: stepfather/stephousband, conflict, an accidental authority, periodical guest. Data which has been collected from the interviews with 141 families for 7 years (similar research in the sailor's families was conducted by Szczecin scientists for ex. in the 90'). The first author among scientific interests gives *maritime sociology*.

(http://www.springerlink.com/content/g132122543830571/)

Maritime sociology is lectured at another American university (http://usouthal.edu/bulletin/coursy.htm) - it gives sociological basis for the research in the relationships among human communities, technology and maritime resources.

At http://www.wm.edu/catalog/2002-03/sociology.htm we have a short desription of maritime sociology as a science (one of those which are lectured), which provide us with the descriptions and analyses of life style of people who have maritime professions and live in the coastal area. According to the desription maritime sociology concentates upon the comparison of overland and "on board" life styles, studying of specific workplaces, which are connected with maritime economy, and isolated fishery societies.

Issues concerning maritime sociology are raised not only in the didactic area, but also for scientific and research purposes. Below there are some examples of publications in a well kown English-speaking scientific magazines:

- the interest in maritime theme among social studies is seen in objective forms of book publications for ex.: *Gamrie: An Exploration In Cultural Ecology: A Study of Maritime Adaptations In a Scottish Fishing Village* by Ed Knipe (critique by Paul Thomson)[107]

[107] Thompson Paul, 1985, *Gamrie: An Exploration In Cultural Ecology: A Study of Maritime Adaptations In a Scottish Fishing Village. Book review*, w: Sociology; Feb85, vol. 19, Issue 1, p.164

13 Moran Emiho, F., 1981, *Human Adaptation to Arctic Zones*, in: Annual Review of Anthropology, vol. 10, p.1-25

- Social and cultural adaptations to cold coastal areas are very often analysed by the anthropologists. One of the examples might be the research in the arctic areas and published report[108]
- Theme of work organizing in maritime environment, in maritime professions, is also raised, for ex. article of Carolyn Ellis in *Qualitative Sociology*[109]

The examples of more fresh publications include research in the influence of religion on the coastal societies in Canada (critique of book by ed. Ch.H. Scobble, and G.A. Rawlyk by Irving),[110] fishermen's laws in the context of ownership laws and privatization process (Wiber), or, published only in some part, work by Norbert Elias *The Genesis of the Naval Profession* (Moelker[111]).

It is important to seek opportunities to engage in the cycle of the thought exchange, ideas related to the maritime theme and social studies. One of such possibilities is a partnership with English-speaking magazines of such profile – for example with scientific journal *Maritime Anthropological Studies* about coastal communities, which used to be published twice a year by the Department of Anthropology at the University in Amsterdam. It is currently comming out with the similar frequency as MAST (Maritime Studies), since 2002 with a slightly different orientation – less of the social studies, more economics and maritime economy, policy and ecology. When reactivating the journal after the break in publishing in the years 1988-1993, in 2002 editors Roban van Ginkel and Jojada Verrips declared that they would welcome multi- and interdisciplinary texts, theoretical and methodological reflections and reports on empirical research, dealing with such topics as: traditional ecological knowledge, legal pluralism, integrated coastal zone management, marine policy analysis, social and cultural representations of marine life and marine social

14 Ellis Carolyn, 1985, Fishing for Success Without Rocking the Boat: Value Conflict and Work Control In a Maritime Context, in: Qualitative Sociology, Fall 1985, vol. 8, issue 3, p. 203-223

[110] Irving Danielle, 1998, *The Contribution of Presbyterianism to the Maritime Provinces of Canada. Book review*, w: Sociology of Religion, Summer 1998, vol. 59, issue 2, p.190-1

[111] Moelker Rene, *Norbert Elias, maritime supremacy and the naval profession: on Elias' unpublished studies in the genesis of the naval profession*, in: British Journal of Sociology, sep2003, vol. 54, issue 3, p 370-91

realities, marine life styles and professional cultures, fisheries and fishing cultures, the life of sailors, crews from drilling platforms, marine tourism (www.marecentre.nl/mast/policy.html).

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